

One Spirit With Christ

Understanding our spiritual union with Jesus

“But he who is joined to the Lord is one spirit with Him.” — 1 Corinthians 6:17

The Christian's union with Christ is one of the deepest realities of the gospel. It does not mean that the believer becomes God or ceases to be a distinct person. It means that, through the Holy Spirit, the believer is brought into a real spiritual union and fellowship with Christ.

1. What does it mean to be “one spirit” with Christ?

Paul's statement in 1 Corinthians 6:17 describes a profound spiritual union. The believer is joined to the Lord through the Holy Spirit. This union is relational and spiritual: Christ is not distant from the believer, and the believer's life is no longer understood apart from Him.

At the same time, Christian union does not erase the distinction between Christ and the believer. Jesus remains Lord, and the believer remains a human person who lives by grace. Union means participation, fellowship, belonging, and shared life through the Spirit.

2. Christ lives in me

Paul could say, “Christ lives in me” (Galatians 2:20). This does not mean that the believer becomes Christ. It means that the believer's old self-directed way of living is surrendered and a new Christ-centred life is being expressed through faith.

The Christian life therefore becomes more than trying to imitate Jesus from a distance. It is learning to live from a relationship with the living Christ and allowing His character and purposes to shape our lives.

3. One life, different persons

Jesus prayed that His followers would be one in a way that reflects the unity of the Father and the Son (John 17:20–23). Christian unity does not mean everyone becomes the same person. It means people who remain distinct are brought together in love, purpose, and fellowship with God.

In the same way, being joined to Christ does not make the believer divine by nature. It means belonging to Him and sharing in the life He gives through the Holy Spirit.

4. The Holy Spirit makes this fellowship real

The Holy Spirit is central to our experience of union with Christ. Scripture speaks of Christ being in believers and believers being in Christ, while also teaching that the Spirit dwells in God's people (Romans 8:9–11).

This changes how we understand everyday life. Prayer is not speaking into an empty distance. Scripture is not merely information. Worship is not performance. The believer is learning to live consciously in fellowship with God.

5. What changes when I know I belong to Christ?

Identity: I no longer have to build my worth entirely from achievement, approval, status, or failure.

Confidence: My relationship with God rests on Christ's grace rather than my perfect performance.

Holiness: I do not pursue holiness merely to look religious; I respond to the life and calling I have received in Christ.

Love: Union with Christ should increasingly affect how I treat other people.

Purpose: My life becomes available for Christ's purposes rather than being centred only on myself.

6. Living from union rather than striving

There is a difference between spiritual striving and spiritual cooperation. We cannot manufacture the life of Christ through human strength. Yet we are called to abide, believe, obey, pray, renew our minds, resist sin, and love others.

These practices do not create our union with Christ; they help us consciously live from the relationship we have already received by grace.

Study: John 15:1–5; Colossians 2:6–7; Galatians 5:16–25.

7. A simple daily confession

I belong to Jesus. I am joined to the Lord by His Spirit. I do not need to manufacture spiritual life from myself. Christ is my life, my confidence, and my foundation. I will remain in Him, receive from Him, and allow His love and character to be expressed through me.

Scripture pathway

1 Corinthians 6:17 — Joined to the Lord, one spirit.

Galatians 2:20 — Christ living in the believer.

John 15:1–5 — Abiding in Christ.

Romans 8:9–11 — The Spirit dwelling in believers.

John 17:20–23 — Jesus' prayer for spiritual unity.

Personal Reflection

- Am I relating to Jesus as someone distant, or am I consciously living in fellowship with Him?
- What would change in my daily life if I genuinely lived from the reality that I belong to Christ?
- Where am I still trying to earn through effort what grace has already given me?

A Prayer

Lord Jesus, thank You that I belong to You. Teach me to understand the depth of being joined to You through the Holy Spirit. Help me not to live from fear, self-effort, or spiritual performance, but from grace, faith, and fellowship with You. Let Your character be formed in me and Your life be expressed through me. Amen.

The phrase "one spirit with Christ" is used here in the biblical sense of spiritual union and fellowship. It should not be understood as the believer becoming God or becoming identical with Jesus in nature.